



Cardioplegia: Antegrade Root

Delivering, maintaining, and documenting myocardial protection — clear communication at every step

1

Flush Up On Plegia

- Clamp off
- S5: cardioplegia
- Cardioplegia on

"Flushing up on plegia"

FLUSH CHECKLIST

- ☐ Line air free
- ☐ Roller pumps rotating & correct ratio
- ☐ Crystalloid cardioplegia mixing w/ blood
- ☐ Blood at surgical site (good mixing)
- ☐ Temperature

2

Plegia Off

"Plegia OFF"

3

Trickle

"Trickle"

4

Off

- Clamp on
- Disengage

"Off"

5

Mental Note Of

- Arterial line pressure
- MAP
- Flow

6

Flow Down

500 mls

"Flow down"

7

Start X-Clamp Timer

8

Flow Back Up, X-Clamp On, Run Cardioplegia

+/- first 50 into vent

Quickly to full flow but...

⚠

PAUSE

Check arterial line pressure

9

Plegia Running

- Cardioplegia / root pressure ↑ — close aortic valve
- Maintain cardioplegia pressure 220–240 mmHg
- This should equal approx. 300 mls/min

- Observe arrest

- Complete dose administration

10

Plegia Off

11

Root Vent On

Watch of vent volume ↑↓ as needed

12

Documentation

"X-clamp on, flow coming back up"

REMEMBER

- ☐ Clamp off plegia line
- ☐ Cardioplegia delivery
- ☐ Plegia on

"Running cardioplegia 1L, cold, antegrade into root"

CLEAR COMMUNICATION

- ☐ Volume
- ☐ Temperature
- ☐ Direction
- ☐ Location

"Hrt arrested at 150mls"

"That's 1 litre of plegia in"

"Plegia OFF"

REMEMBER

- ☐ Clamp on
- ☐ Disengage
- ☐ Change ratio 16:1
- ☐ Start count down timer

"Root vent on"

At 200

- ☐ CPB details
- ☐ Plegia details
- ☐ ABG + ACT